

FIELDSCHOLAR

A Global Learning Companion

Project Overview

FieldScholar is a mobile-first platform for study abroad, experiential learning, field research, and university-sponsored travel. It brings program logistics, student support, safety, academic fieldwork, and faculty administration into one program-specific environment while complementing Canvas, email, and other institutional systems.

CURRENT PLATFORM STATE

Functional pilot

A live, configurable student/faculty experience that can support a faculty-led program end to end.

Institutional architecture

A multi-institution, multi-program domain and membership layer implemented and validated in the development codebase.

Protected pilot

The existing pilot remains intact; platform-expansion work is isolated from the production pilot and its data.

WHAT FIELDSCHOLAR BRINGS TO A PROGRAM

Program logistics

Schedules, housing, trips, maps, meeting points, program resources, and in-country information.

Academic fieldwork

Field notes, site observations, guided reflections, course resources, and place-based learning activities.

Safety & support

Emergency contacts, direct faculty communication, the student-facing I AM SAFE action, and voluntary one-time location sharing.

Faculty / administration

Program setup, student records, homestays, itinerary management, participant tools, and safety content.

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CURRENT FIELD SCHOLAR CAPABILITIES

The current pilot is designed around the day-to-day needs of students and faculty while they are away from campus. The interface is mobile-first and can also be used in a desktop browser.

Restricted access

Approved participants only. Student and faculty/admin paths are separated, and administrative tools require an additional faculty verification step.

Safety Center

Emergency contacts and the student-only I AM SAFE action. Tapping it opens a prefilled WhatsApp message to the configured program contact without requiring a backend write or location tracking.

Faculty/admin tools

Program configuration, student records, homestays, itinerary editing, emergency and safety content, arrival roster, participant export, and related operational tools.

Student home

Course tools, housing and stay information, itinerary, notes, guided reflections, program guide, maps, and direct communication pathways.

One-time location sharing

A separate student-initiated action can share the current location once, after confirmation. FieldScholar does not continuously track students in the background.

Notes & reflections

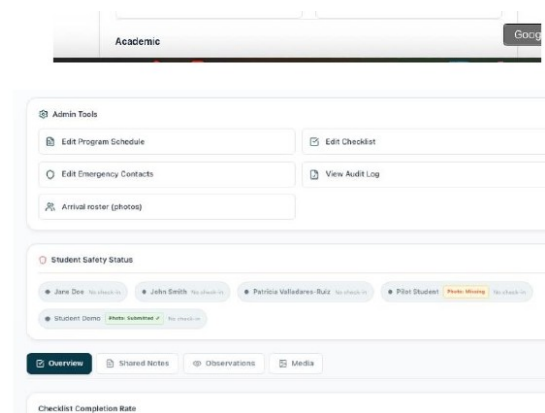
Students can create field notes and complete guided reflection activities that connect program mobility with experiential learning.

THE PRODUCT IN USE

- "I am Safe" check-in (one-tap confirmation used when requested)
- Emergency Contacts



Student Safety Center



Faculty dashboard

MULTI-INSTITUTION PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE

FieldScholar is being developed as one configurable platform rather than as separate codebases for individual programs. Its canonical hierarchy is:

INSTITUTION → PROGRAM → COHORT → MEMBERSHIP / USER → ROLE → DATA

IMPLEMENTED AND VALIDATED PLATFORM LAYER

The platform-expansion branch includes the institutional foundation needed to move beyond a single-program pilot, while leaving the live pilot unchanged.

Membership API & tenant isolation

Institution-scoped access, membership create/suspend/remove operations, and atomic audit records.

Multi-program / cohort isolation

Persistence and authorization checks that separate users and data across programs and cohorts.

Atomic roster import

CSV dry-run validation and atomic creation of up to 249 memberships in one operation.

Program & cohort creation

Authorized server-side creation with audit records.

Institution provisioning

Operator-only institution and first-admin provisioning, plus institutional-context resolution.

Institution-scoped admin UI

An isolated platform-admin interface and tested program → cohort → roster workflow.

ARCHITECTURAL PRINCIPLES

- One core codebase with institution- and program-specific configuration rather than separate forks.
- Server-side tenant isolation, role-based permissions, and a secure backend as the authoritative source of persistent data.
- Voluntary, event-based location sharing; FieldScholar does not use continuous location tracking.
- Preservation of a stable pilot while institutional architecture is developed and validated separately.

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